

English SP

Terra-cotta Warriors, in Color

Open-ended questions

TODAY'S lesson

10 Vocabulary items

**9 Open-ended questions
(12 marks)**

Key vocabulary: match the meanings

1 **spectacle** Line 1

2 **buried** Line 2

3 **emperor** Line 3

4 **archaeologists** Line 3

5 **fragments** Line 22

6 **warriors** Line 28

7 **grandiose** Line 36

8 **serendipity** Line 62

9 **excavation** Line 65

10 **remnants** Line 91

C

A. A king who rules a large country (an empire).

E

B. Small broken pieces of something.

A

C. An exciting show or scene that you watch.

J

D. Digging in the ground to find old things.

B

E. Put underground; covered with earth.

I

F. Small parts that are left over; remains.

H

G. Good luck; finding something good by chance.

G

H. Very grand and impressive; bigger than necessary.

D

I. Soldiers who fight in battles.

F

J. Scientists who study old things found in the ground.

What helps you gain the mark?

Hunting for reasons, purposes & intentions

1 Easy to spot

because · since · as · due to · thanks to
so that · to + verb · in order to

e.g. The paint flaked off because the air was dry.

2 Easy to miss — watch out!

given + noun · with + noun · out of + noun
prompted by · driven by · in an attempt to
so as to · for fear of · in response to

e.g. given the low fee = because the fee is low

Punctuation clues — read to the RIGHT of the mark

— : “ ” () ; → the reason / explanation follows the mark

Let's try the open-ended questions (12 marks)

Finding the purpose — demo 1

(demo — not from the examination paper)

Every day, Hong Kong restaurants throw away hundreds of tonnes of edible food. To fight this waste, a charity has launched a 'surprise meal' scheme: chefs collect leftover ingredients and turn them into three-course dinners sold for a sixth of the normal price — the aim is simple, to keep good food out of the landfill. 'We are not a soup kitchen,' says founder Grace Lam. 'We are a rescue team.' Customers pay what they can, and anyone who cannot pay eats for free.

What is the purpose of the 'surprise meal' scheme?

Model answer: To keep good food out of the landfill / to reduce the amount of edible food being wasted.

Clues: the colon after 'scheme:' and the dash after 'normal price —' — read to the RIGHT. 'To fight this waste' at the start also gives the aim. (PURPOSE → answer starts with 'to ...')

Finding the reason — demo 2

(demo — not from the examination paper)

Every summer, the city's Maritime Museum hosts a model-ship race for children. Families crowd the harbour wall to watch the race, which lasts only ten minutes — the real goal is to draw young visitors into the exhibition halls. Visitors who race a boat usually beg their parents for a second visit; given the museum's modest entrance fee, few families refuse.

According to the paragraph, why do few families refuse a second visit to the museum?

Model answer: Because the museum's entrance fee is low / modest.

Clues: 'given + noun' is an easy-to-miss reason signal. Read the second half after the semicolon: 'given the museum's modest entrance fee, few families refuse.' (REASON → answer gives the CAUSE)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

1. What does 'the task' (line 23) refer to?

20 [3] It usually takes Yang and her co-workers many days to transform a heap of clay fragments into a full-size warrior, but today they are lucky, accomplishing the task in a matter of hours. Yang has been solving such puzzles since

It refers to transforming / rebuilding a heap of clay fragments into a full-size warrior — reassembling an army of terra-cotta warriors.

Evidence & explanation

Paragraph 3 (lines 20–23): “...many days to transform a heap of clay fragments into a full-size warrior, but today they are lucky, accomplishing the task in a matter of hours.” — ‘the task’ looks back at the sentence before it. (1 mark · 70%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

2. According to paragraph 3, what were the farmers doing when they first discovered the terra-cotta warriors?

hours. Yang has been solving such puzzles since
25 1974, when farmers from her village of Xiyang
first unearthed pottery and a sculpted head while
digging a well for their orchard. Having helped

They were digging a well (for their orchard).

Evidence & explanation

Paragraph 3 (lines 24–27): “...farmers from her village of Xiyang first unearthed pottery and a sculpted head while digging a well for their orchard.” — ‘digging’ alone loses the mark; the answer must include the well. (1 mark · 47%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

3. Find a word in paragraph 4 that means 'not colorful'.

[4] The monochrome figures that visitors to Xian's terra-cotta army museum see today
35 actually began as the multicolored fantasy of a ruler whose grandiose ambitions extended beyond the mortal realm. The first emperor to unify China under a single dynasty Qin Shi

monochrome

Evidence & explanation

Paragraph 4 (line 33): "The monochrome figures that visitors to Xian's terra-cotta army museum see today..." — mono = one, chrome = colour. (1 mark · 37%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

4. According to paragraph 5, why did the colors of the warriors not survive?

... colors: red and green, purple and yellow.
Sadly, most of the colors did not survive the
crucible of time — or the exposure to air that
comes with discovery and excavation. In earlier
55 digs, archaeologists often watched helplessly as
the warriors' colors disintegrated in the dry
Xian air. One study showed that once exposed,

**Because the colors were exposed to the
(dry Xian) air and disintegrated.**

Evidence & explanation

Paragraph 5 (lines 51–56): “...most of the colors did not survive the crucible of time — or the exposure to air that comes with discovery and excavation. ... the warriors’ colors disintegrated in the dry Xian air.” — a ‘why’ answer names the CAUSE. (1 mark · 83%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

5. In line 61, the writer mentions boiling an egg to show...

Xian air. One study showed that once exposed, the lacquer underneath the paint begins to curl after 15 seconds and flake off in just four minutes — vibrant pieces of history lost in the time it takes to boil an egg.

...how quickly / fast the paint begins to curl and flake off — vibrant pieces of history are lost in a very short time.

Evidence & explanation

Lines 58-61: "...the lacquer underneath the paint begins to curl after 15 seconds and flake off in just four minutes — vibrant pieces of history lost in the time it takes to boil an egg." — 'to show...' asks what the example demonstrates. (1 mark · 38%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

6. Who developed PEG (line 76)?

[7] Almost thirty years ago, (

75 researchers started working with exper

the Conservation Office in Germany to (

a preservative known as PEG to help s

warriors' colors. During a recent excavat

Chinese researchers (working together)
with experts from the Conservation Office
in Germany.

Evidence & explanation

Paragraph 7 (lines 74–76): “Almost thirty years ago, Chinese researchers started working with experts from the Conservation Office in Germany to develop a preservative known as PEG...” — both groups; naming one side loses the mark. (1 mark · 40%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

7. What is the purpose of wrapping the artifact in plastic?

80 warriors' colors. During a recent excavat
moment a painted artifact was un
workers sprayed any bit of exposed col
the solution, then wrapped it in plastic to
the protective moisture. The most
pieces (and the earth surrounding ther
been removed to an on-site laborat

To keep in the protective moisture / to keep the artifact wet / to protect it from the dry air.

Evidence & explanation

Paragraph 7 (lines 79–81): "...workers sprayed any bit of exposed color with the solution, then wrapped it in plastic to keep in the protective moisture." — purpose answers start with 'to...' / 'so that...'. (1 mark · 74%)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

8. According to Rong Bo, why should the earth be treated like an artifact (lines 112–113)?

[10] With so much color and artistry imprinted on the soil — the ancient paint, alas, adheres to dirt more readily than to lacquer — Chinese preservationists are now trying to preserve the earth itself. ‘We are creating the earth as an artifact,’ says Rong Bo, the museum’s head chemist, who helped develop a

Because so much color and artistry has been imprinted on the soil — the ancient paint adheres to dirt more readily than to lacquer.

Evidence & explanation

Paragraph 10 (lines 110–113): “With so much color and artistry imprinted on the soil — the ancient paint, alas, adheres to dirt more readily than to lacquer — ... We are treating the earth as an artifact.” — the soil itself holds the paint. (1 mark · 28% — hardest in this lesson)

Read the paragraph — then write your answer

9. Use ONE word to complete each blank. Make sure your answers are grammatically correct, paying attention to word form, plurals, etc.

The next challenge for (i) _____ is to (ii) _____ a procedure for (iii) _____ color to the warriors now that a (iv) _____ has been developed to hold together the soil.

‘earth as an artifact,’ says Rong Bo, the museum’s head chemist, who helped develop a binding agent that holds the soil together so the color won’t be lost. The next challenge, Rong says, will be to find an acceptable method for reapplying this color to the warriors.

- (i) Rong (Bo) / chemists / researchers / scientists / experts
- (ii) create / find / develop / discover / invent
- (iii) (re)applying
- (iv) binding agent

Evidence & explanation

Paragraph 10 (lines 112–118): “...Rong Bo, the museum’s head chemist, who helped develop a binding agent that holds the soil together ... The next challenge, Rong says, will be to find an acceptable method for reapplying this color to the warriors.” (i) 47% · (ii) 62% · (iii) 63% · (iv) 63%